

Name: Johana Bigini

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- 1. Explain when you would use a SQL View.**
- 2. Explain the differences and similarities between a View, Function, and Stored Procedure.**

A SQL View is something I would use when I want to make data easier to look at or easier to reuse later. A View acts like a saved query that pulls information from one or more tables and shows it like a virtual table. For example, instead of asking SQL to join Products, Categories, and Inventories every single time, I can create a View once and simply select from that View whenever I need the information again. I think of a View almost like a shortcut or a custom report because it helps organize information in a simpler way without changing the original data stored in the tables.

Views, Functions, and Stored Procedures are similar because they are all tools that help make databases easier to work with and reduce repeating the same SQL code over and over again. A View is mainly used to display data in a cleaner and simpler format. A Function is more focused on calculations or returning a value after applying some logic, similar to using a formula in Excel. A Stored Procedure is different because it can perform actions such as inserting, updating, deleting, or retrieving data, and it can run multiple SQL statements together as one process.

One way I remember the differences is by thinking about their main purpose. A View is mostly for looking at data, a Function is mostly for calculating or returning values, and a Stored Procedure is mostly for performing tasks or automating steps. For someone who does not know SQL, I would compare a View to opening a prepared report, a Function to using a calculator formula, and a Stored Procedure to pressing a button that automatically completes several steps at once. All three are useful because they help keep databases organized, save time, and make systems easier to maintain and understand.